How to Solve Nonograms

Read the clues. Fill what must be black. Mark what must be empty.

Every puzzle in this book can also be played online. Scan the code on page 13.

USE THREE CELL STATES

- **Unknown** — not decided yet
- **Filled** — definitely black
- **Empty** — definitely white

The basic rule

Each clue describes a run of consecutive filled cells. If a line has more than one number, the runs appear in that order, with at least one empty cell between them.



3 2 1 means 3 filled, gap, 2 filled, gap, 1 filled.

Start with certainty

1 Complete lines

If the clue fills the whole line, every cell is known immediately.



2 Squeeze from both ends

For a long run, place it as far left as possible and then as far right as possible. Cells covered both times must be filled.



certain

3 Mark spaces around a completed block

Once a run is complete, cells immediately beside it must be empty. Marking empties often unlocks the next deduction.



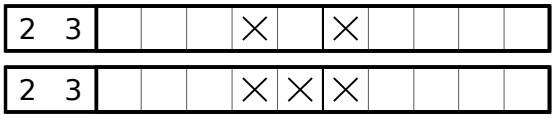
> **Keep switching between rows and columns**
>
> Every confirmed black or empty cell gives new information in the crossing line. Recheck both directions after every discovery.

When the Puzzle Gets Harder

Use stronger deductions only when the simpler ones stop producing new cells.

1 Use what you already know

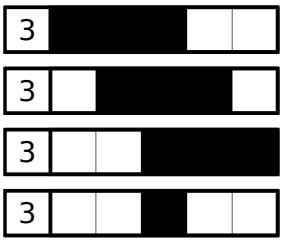
Known empty cells split a line into smaller regions. If a remaining run cannot fit inside a region, those cells can be ruled out.



The one-cell region cannot hold 2 or 3.

2 Keep what every arrangement agrees on

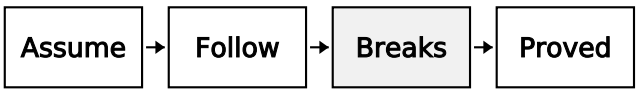
Consider the legal ways the clue can still fit the line. A cell that is filled in every surviving arrangement is certain; a cell empty in every arrangement is certainly empty.



Compare

3 Assume, and watch it break

If everything stalls, temporarily treat one unsettled cell as filled and follow the consequences through its row and column. If a clue becomes impossible, the assumption was wrong.



This is not guessing: erase the temporary trial and keep only what the contradiction proves.

Worked example: the clue 3 1 on a row of 6 squares

1 The clue



The clue 3 1 means a run of 3 filled squares, then at least one empty square, then a run of 1.

2 Overlap



Pushed left, the 3 covers squares 1-3; pushed right, 2-4. Squares 2 and 3 are filled either way.

3 Gap



The column crossing square 1 shows it is empty, so the 3 covers squares 2-4 and square 5 is the gap. Cross out 1 and 5.

4 Solved



The 1 fills square 6.

Difficulty ●○○ EASY ●●○ MEDIUM ●●● HARD

Easy puzzles need only direct deductions; Hard ones need contradiction through much of the grid.

Table of Contents

How to Solve Nonograms 2

Easy
Puzzles 1–2 5

Medium
Puzzle 3 8

Hard
Puzzle 4 10

Solutions 14

Easy

Puzzle 1

●○○ EASY

	1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1										
	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
1 1 1 1 1 1																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					
0																					

Puzzle 2

●○○ EASY

						1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1								
						1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		

Medium

Puzzle 3

●●○ MEDIUM

| | | | | | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1

Hard

Puzzle 4

●●● HARD

						1 1 1 1 1 1	0	1 1 1 1 1 1	0	1 1 1 1 1 1	0	1 1 1 1 1 1	0	1 1 1 1 1 1	0	1 1 1 1 1 1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		

Play online

Scan the code with your phone to play any puzzle in this book, then tap the puzzle's number.



nonogram.adverax.io/b/853b930c7a

SOLUTIONS

Puzzle 1 · Easy

| | | | | | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1

Puzzle 2 · Easy

						1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1							
						1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		

Puzzle 2 — Picture 2

Puzzle 3 · Medium

| | | | | | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1 | | 1
1
1
1
1
1

Puzzle 4 · Hard

						1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1		1 1 1 1 1 1							
						1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
1	1	1	1	1	1	■		■		■		■		■		■							
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		
					0																		

Puzzle 4 — Picture 4